



AI-Node-Gate — Path to Profitability

The audit-grade, sovereign decision layer for human-arbitrated AI · Q1 2026

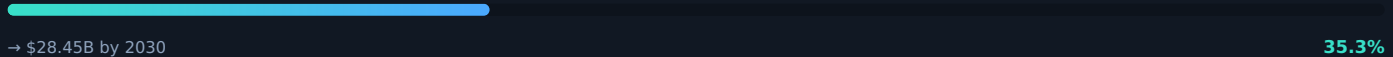
“Put a human signature on every AI decision — and keep the proof on your own hardware.”

AI-Node-Gate is the self-hosted hub where autonomous AI nodes propose, a human decides at the gate, and every decision is Ed25519-signed into a SHA-256 hash-chained ledger that verifies offline. Zero dependencies. One SQLite file. Your keys.

Four markets, one demand: control, observe, and prove what AI does

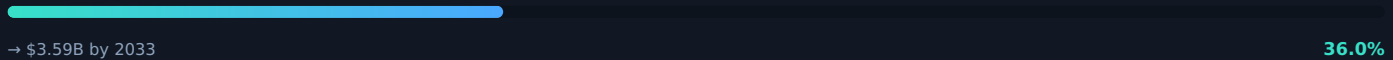
\$6.27_B

Agentic AI orchestration & memory (2025)



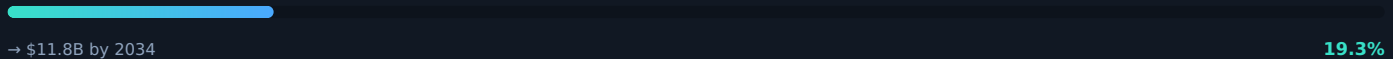
\$308_M

AI governance (2025) — our buyer's budget line



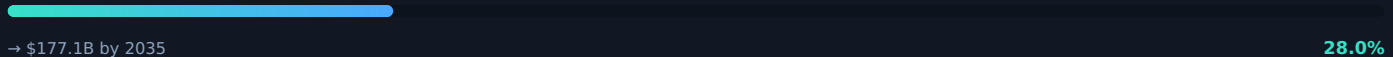
\$2.4_B

Human-in-the-loop AI (2025) — the “human gate”



\$15.0_B

Sovereign AI infrastructure (2025)



Positioning: the gap the incumbents leave

OWNED / SELF-HOSTED

CrewAI Enterprise

AI-Node-Gate

AI governance SaaS

LangSmith (self-host = Ent.)

Scale AI (HITL labor)

Langfuse / Arize

EXECUTES AGENTS

PROVES DECISIONS

Top-right = owned infrastructure **and** provable decisions. That quadrant is nearly empty. Frameworks execute; observability logs; governance dashboards advise. None produce a signed, human-arbitrated, offline-verifiable record you fully own.

Sovereignty is the majority, not a niche

- ▶ **AI governance:** on-premises held the **largest deployment share** (2025); government & defense is the largest vertical.
- ▶ **Sovereign AI infra:** on-premises **dominated** 2025; govt/defense dominated; Europe leads at **34.2%** share.
- ▶ **Human-in-the-loop:** on-premises is **38.7%** of revenue, growing 16.4% CAGR.
- ▶ **Agentic orchestration:** compliance mandates for LLM audit trails are a named growth driver.

Zero dependencies

One SQLite file

Keys, not accounts

Offline verify

Air-gap ready

Regulatory tailwind

EUR 30M

or 6% of global turnover — top EU AI Act penalties. Turns oversight from “nice to have” into mandatory evidence.

Enterprise contracts

>\$5M/yr

HITL enterprise contracts frequently exceed this at the top end. Budget authority already exists.

Already mainstream

67%

of Fortune 500 AI deployers already use human-in-the-loop review. The practice is normal; the proof tooling is not.

Pricing: anchor on comparables, invert the self-host gate

PRODUCT	ENTRY	MID	ENTERPRISE	SELF-HOST
LangSmith (LangChain)	Free (5k traces)	\$39/seat/mo	Custom	Enterprise only
Langfuse	Free (50k units)	\$29-\$199/mo	\$2,499/mo	Yes (OSS)
Arize Phoenix	Free (OSS)	\$50/mo	Custom	Yes (OSS)
Braintrust	Free	\$249/mo	Custom	Limited
CrewAI	Free (50 exec/mo)	—	Custom (VPC/own infra)	Yes (Ent.)
AI-Node-Gate	Free (full core)	\$199-\$499/mo	\$50k-\$500k+/yr	Yes (default)

Community

Free

Full runtime, record format, console, CLI, offline verify — the distribution engine.

Team

\$199-499/mo

Multi-node, basic policy, managed convenience, email support.

Business

\$2,000-2,999/mo

SSO/RBAC, policy enforcement, HA ledger, audit exports. Anchored to Langfuse Enterprise \$2,499.

Sovereign

\$50k-500k+/yr

Non-custodial + hardware keys, air-gapped deploy, compliance packs, SLA, forward-deployed eng.

Feature → revenue roadmap (by impact per effort)

- Tier 1 — unlock enterprise: non-custodial + hardware-backed signing · compliance-evidence packs (EU AI Act / ISO 42001 / SOC 2) · SSO/RBAC/policy.
- Tier 2 — scale: replicated/HA ledger + signed checkpoints · air-gapped appliance kit · compliance onboarding services.
- Tier 3 — moat: coordination intelligence (routing, dependency graphs, confidence) · federation across hubs · optional managed tier.
- Tier 4 — distribution: LangGraph/CrewAI adapters, ServiceNow/Jira bridges, SIEM export · certification & partner program.

Recommended path to profitability

- Open-core, self-hosted-first. Free, complete core; monetize enterprise assurances.
- Beachhead: regulated self-hosted AI — government/defense and BFSI first.
- Wedge: “human signature on every AI decision, proof on your own hardware.”
- Flagship feature: non-custodial, hardware-backed signing — biggest risk, biggest revenue.

- ▶ **Budget-line conversion:** compliance-evidence packs turn the ledger into a must-buy.
- ▶ **Target revenue mix:** ~50% Sovereign · ~25% Business · ~15% services · ~10% OEM/certification.

Sources: Mordor Intelligence (agentic orchestration) · Grand View Research (AI governance) · Dataintel (human-in-the-loop AI) · Precedence Research (sovereign AI infrastructure) · TrueFoundry & Inference.net (LangSmith/Langfuse/Arize/Baintrust/Helicone pricing) · CrewAI pricing · Linux Foundation "State of Commercial Open Source 2025" · European Commission (EU AI Act). Figures reported as published; estimates vary by methodology and are used for direction and order-of-magnitude, not precision.
Prepared for No_Gas_Labs™ — Damien Featherstone · AI-Node-Gate · Q1 2026